



TIA

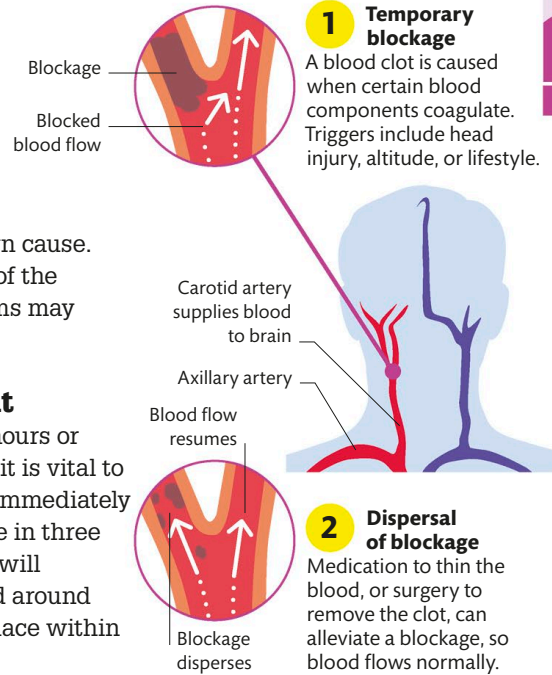
A transient ischemic attack, or TIA, is similar to a stroke (see below), which occurs when the blood supply to the brain is interrupted. Unlike a stroke, however, a TIA lasts only briefly.

A TIA is often termed a “mini stroke” and may serve as a warning sign. Indications of a TIA usually disappear within an hour and resemble those found early in a stroke. Symptoms include the sudden onset of weakness, paralysis, or numbness in the face, arm, or leg, typically on one side of the body; slurred speech and difficulty understanding others; blindness or double vision; dizziness or loss of balance or coordination; and a sudden severe

headache with no known cause. Depending on the area of the brain involved, symptoms may be similar or different.

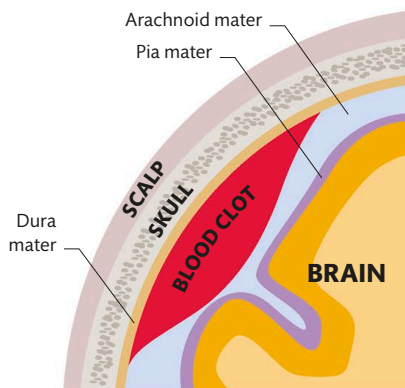
Seeking treatment

TIA's most often occur hours or days before a stroke, so it is vital to seek medical attention immediately after a TIA. Roughly one in three people who have a TIA will experience a stroke, and around half of these will take place within a year of the initial TIA.



Stroke and hemorrhage

A stroke is a life-threatening condition that occurs when the blood supply to the brain is cut off. There are two main types of strokes: ischemic and hemorrhagic, and each affects the brain in different ways.



Subdural hematoma (hemorrhage)

Bleeding between the brain's protective outer layers, the meninges, forms a clot that puts pressure on the brain, causing a stroke.

If the blood supply to the brain is reduced or interrupted, brain tissue is deprived of oxygen and nutrients. When this happens, brain cells begin to die within minutes. A stroke can be caused by a blockage, usually a blood clot (ischemic), or when blood spills into the brain or its surrounding tissues (hemorrhagic), often as the result of a ruptured blood vessel or artery.

Symptoms can include slurred speech; paralysis (drooping) or numbness of the face, arm, or leg, which often occurs on just one side of the body; trouble seeing with

IN THE US
SOMEONE
HAS A STROKE
EVERY 40 SECONDS



one or both eyes; and a sudden, severe headache, dizziness, and loss of coordination.

Blood in the brain

Brain hemorrhages can be caused by weak spots in blood vessels that form an aneurysm, or swelling, which bursts, often due to high blood pressure. If this occurs between the two inner membranes surrounding the brain, it is called a subarachnoid hemorrhage. Causes of bleeding within brain tissue (intracerebral hemorrhage) include injury, tumors, or drug use.